Northampton County Badminton Association

Eligibility Policy

2026 - 2027

Eligibility for County Squads

To be eligible for Northamptonshire Junior County representation, players must satisfy at least one of the following criteria:

1. **Have been born in Northamptonshire; or**
2. **Live in Northamptonshire; or**
3. **Attend a school in Northamptonshire; or**
4. **Complete an authorised transfer from a neighbouring county (details available on request).**

Players will normally be selected for County Squads through the Northamptonshire County Badminton trials held in May or June each year. Players who are unable to attend the trials should notify Northamptonshire County Badminton of their intention to be considered for selection. Players may be added to a squad at any point during the season at the discretion of the coaching team.

Eligibility for County Matches

In addition to the criteria above, players are expected to:

5. **Attend Northamptonshire County Badminton training sessions regularly with their relevant squad*.**
6. **Demonstrate commitment to their badminton development through participation in appropriate competitive opportunities, including county competitions and Badminton England-sanctioned tournaments.**
7. **Maintain a level of competitive activity sufficient to enable the coaching team to assess performance, progress, and readiness for county match play.**

The coaching team may consider individual circumstances, including age, experience, injury, academic commitments, travel requirements, and other relevant factors when determining eligibility and selection.

* In exceptional circumstances, players may be permitted to forego county training, but only with the agreement of the Head Coach and Assistant Coach. Each case will be considered individually on its own merits.

Under-18 Inter Counties Tournament (ICT)

The Inter Counties Tournament represents the highest level of junior county competition and requires players to be capable of performing under significant competitive pressure.

In addition to the criteria above, players wishing to be considered for ICT selection should:

8. **Represent Northamptonshire in county matches during the season where selected and available.**
9. **Attend ICT preparation and training sessions, unless otherwise agreed by the coaching team.**
10. **Demonstrate an appropriate level of competitive experience through participation in tournaments and match play during the season.**

Players are strongly encouraged to:

- Attend county training regularly.
- Compete in the Northamptonshire County Age Group Competition Tournament.
- Enter Badminton England-sanctioned tournaments throughout the season.
- Seek regular competitive match opportunities, including club league matches and other organised competitions, to aid their development and prepare for ICT competition.

Selection for ICT

Meeting the eligibility requirements does not guarantee selection.
ICT selection will be made by the Head Coach based on a combination of factors including:

- Playing ability and performance.
- Competitive results and form.
- Commitment to training and county activities.
- Attitude, conduct, and professionalism.
- Availability for the event and preparation sessions.
- Readiness to compete at ICT level.

The Head Coach reserves the right to take individual circumstances into account when making selection decisions.

The Head Coach shall have discretion, in exceptional circumstances, to waive or vary any aspect of this policy where it is considered to be in the best interests of the player and/or Northamptonshire County Badminton. Such decisions will be made on a case-by-case basis, considering all relevant factors, and shall be final.

Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually by Northamptonshire County Badminton.

For any queries regarding this policy, please contact the Northamptonshire County Badminton Committee via: info@nscba.co.uk or secretary@nscba.co.uk